My vort for אלול, which was inspired by a number of people including Rabbi Oelbaum, is as follows: We know that the month of אלול is distinctive in that every day we say לְדָוִד ה׳ אוֹרִי וְיִשְׁעִי. In that קאַפּיטל there's the pasuk אַחַת שָׁאַלְתִּי מֵאֵת ה׳ - there is only one thing that I'm asking for. Then we go home and we wash and we have a nice fresh roll and a little scrambled egg or whatever, and then we bentch. In bentching we say:

לְחֵן וּלְחֶסֶד וּלְרַחֲמִים וּלְרֶוַח הַצָּלָה וְהַצְלָחָה בְּרָכָה וִישׁוּעָה, נֶחָמָה, פַּרְנָסָה וְכַלְכָּלָה, וְרַחֲמִים, וְחַיִּים - I need הקדוש ברוך הוא. וּמִכָּל טוּב לְעוֹלָם אַל יְחַסְּרֵנוּ - If I forgot something, please throw in all the other good stuff that You can do. And הקדוש ברוך הוא, in case I left anything out, וְשָׁלוֹם, וְכָל טוֹב.

So hang on. Ten seconds ago, you said, I'm only asking You one thing, אַחַת שָׁאַלְתִּי. And now you're asking an entire list. It's an endless list. וּמִכָּל טוּב לְעוֹלָם אַל יְחַסְּרֵנוּ - it's an infinite list.

The תירוץ is there is one thing in bentching that we do not want. לֹא לִידֵי מַתְּנַת בָּשָׂר וָדָם - everything that I need should come directly from you, not from מַתְּנַת בָּשָׂר וָדָם. חס ושלום, we should never have to come on to מַתְּנַת בָּשָׂר וָדָם. Let me ask you a question. A kid comes home from school and he says, 'Ma, what's for supper?' So she gives him supper. Is that called מַתְּנַת בָּשָׂר וָדָם? An older kid asks, 'Daddy, I'm getting בר מצוה, can I have a Borsalino?' 'Okay, you can have a Borsalino.' Is that מַתְּנַת בָּשָׂר וָדָם? An even older kid comes along and says, 'Dad, can I borrow the car keys?' Is that מַתְּנַת בָּשָׂר וָדָם? And even better, 'Can I have a car?' Is that מַתְּנַת בָּשָׂר וָדָם? No, that's not מַתְּנַת בָּשָׂר וָדָם. Why? Because that's called משפחה, that's called your family. When you're getting something from your father, mother, and family, that's not מַתְּנַת בָּשָׂר וָדָם.

What are we asking Hashem? אַחַת שָׁאַלְתִּי מֵאֵת ה׳ ... שִׁבְתִּי בְּבֵית ה׳ כָּל יְמֵי חַיַּי - Hashem, I want to live in Your house. I want to be part of your משפחה. I want to be close to You, as close as a father and a mother. When you ask הקדוש ברוך הוא שִׁבְתִּי בְּבֵית ה׳ כָּל יְמֵי חַיַּי, that I want to live in Your house, then you can ask for everything. That's why when we bentch, we can ask for everything. May we be זוכה that הקדוש ברוך הוא give us all the good things we ask for לטובה, and to have a wonderful כתיבה וחתימה טובה.

https://youtu.be/mL1TKhS4B2o